Brian A. Chesko

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SUMMARY

Infrastructure engineer with 5 years building and operating the distributed systems, deployment tooling, and observability layers that other engineers and operators depend on in safety-critical production environments. Track record of turning fast-moving, user-driven requirements into reliable production infrastructure (Go, Python, C++, Kubernetes, gRPC, Bazel), and of debugging performance and correctness issues across unfamiliar parts of the stack under real operational pressure.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ground Software Engineer, Lead — Relativity Space, Stennis Space Center, MS

Apr 2026 – Present

- **Platform leadership:** Lead the full-stack Platform group (4 direct reports) that owns the tooling, deployment infrastructure, and system-management layer 100+ engineers and operators depend on within a safety-critical control software environment
- **Go/gRPC services:** Rescoped and shipped an MVP Go/gRPC overhaul of a configuration deployment and state-management service in 4 weeks after direct user interviews surfaced it as a high-priority unmet need, then iterated it to full production delivery
- Own roadmap and mentor 4 direct reports while continuing hands-on IC work across the platform

Senior Ground Software Engineer — Relativity Space, Stennis Space Center, MS

Dec 2024 – Apr 2026

- **C++ systems:** Built and operated full-stack, low-latency Linux data acquisition and control services on a distributed pub/sub architecture (C++23, DDS), achieving sub-millisecond control authority in a production, safety-critical system
- Co-owned Kubernetes deployment infrastructure-as-code across 20+ independent production environments; migrated critical services to enable automatic restarts, controlled rollouts, and improved reliability
- **Developer tooling:** Built developer CLI and pipeline tooling (Go, Python, Bash) — from one-off scripts to fully representative local deployment environments — to shorten the iteration loop for engineers building on the platform
- **CI/build systems:** Designed and shipped a Bazel-based configuration framework (Starlark rules/macros/providers) used by 100+ semi-technical operators as a dependency, and re-architected CI pipelines (GitLab CI, GoogleTest, Pytest), cutting median pipeline time from 20 to 5 minutes

Ground Software Engineer II — Relativity Space, Stennis Space Center, MS

Feb 2023 – Dec 2024

- **Internal platform-as-a-service:** Architected and delivered a full-stack internal platform-as-a-service (Go, gRPC, Ansible, Docker, Helm/Kubernetes) for provisioning, configuring, and monitoring 100+ bare-metal hosts and industrial PCs across multiple sites
- Built the full application layer — REST/gRPC APIs, database schemas, and OpenTelemetry observability dashboards — giving 30+ operators correctness checks and visibility into system state at scale
- **C++ systems:** Refactored a performance-critical C++ service from a blocking multithreaded model to an event-driven (Boost.Asio) architecture, debugging contention issues to improve responsiveness under load

Ground Software Engineer I — Relativity Space, Stennis Space Center, MS

Oct 2021 – Feb 2023

- Built tooling enabling 30+ operators across 3 sites to create custom GUIs in Ignition SCADA and tailor operational workflows to their own needs
- Provided real-time support during high-stakes test and launch operations, diagnosing issues and safely patching live production systems under time pressure

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science & B.S. Mechanical Engineering — Rowan University, Glassboro, NJ

May 2021

Honors Concentration; Minor in Mathematics

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Intern, Electrified Aircraft Propulsion — NASA Glenn Research Center

Summer 2020

Developed real-time Simulink simulation components for a high-lift motor controller system

Software Engineering Intern, Backend → Frontend — Clover Network, Inc.

Summer 2018 – Summer 2019

Built RESTful API endpoints and associated frontend components on a Java/Hibernate/React stack